

L-51 Topics — PYQ Mapping & Answer Pointers

Anthropology Paper 2 (Chapters 4, 5.2, 5.3, 5.3a) + GS1 Society | UPSC CSE

Trend Analysis — How Often These Topics Appear

Topic	Frequency (2010–2024)	Pattern
Sanskritization/Westernization/Modernization	Almost every year (direct or indirect)	Often asked as compare/contrast; linked to social change processes; GS1 also asks
Religious Minorities	Every 2-3 years	Often in GS1/GS2; Anthropology asks through communalism/identity lens
Linguistic Minorities	Every 3-4 years	Often clubbed with diversity/integration; tribal language angle
Growth of Anthropology in India	Every 2-3 years	Direct question on phases/contributions; or as part of "relevance of anthropology"
Panchayati Raj & Social Change	Every year (GS2/GS1); every 2 yrs (Anthro)	Anthro angle = tribal self-governance (PESA), social change tool
Media & Social Change	Every 2-3 years	Often paired with modernization; asked in GS1 as "role of media"

1. Sanskritization / Westernization / Modernization

Year	Paper	Marks	Question	Answer Pointers
2024	Anthro P2	10	Discuss the relevance of Sanskritization in understanding social change in contemporary India.	• Srinivas (1952) definition + dominant caste models • Paradox: status claim + retain backward status • New agents (media, online poojas) • Harold Gould (repressed hostility) • Singer/Rowe critique (political participation now dominant) • Case: Rajwars, Koyaris claiming Kshatriya
2023	GS1	15	Are the processes of Sanskritization and These Westernization complementary or contradictory? Discuss.	• Srinivas: accelerates (railways/media) + weakens (class > caste) • Gould: once fully Sanskritized → Western lifestyle as distinction • Both coexist simultaneously • Give regional examples + conclude they are both complementary AND contradictory depending on context
2022	Anthro P2	10	Critically examine the concept of Westernization. Is it relevant to understanding Indian society today?	• Srinivas definition (150+ yrs British rule) • 5 limitations (Eurocentric, static West, ignores resistance) • 3 global views (Huntington/Mahbubani/Said) • Still relevant: English education, democracy, reforms • But selective adoption, indigenous modernization exist
2021	GS1	15	Has caste lost its relevance in understanding the multi-cultural Indian Society? Elaborate your answer with illustrations.	• Sanskritization still operates (online Tirupati, regional claims) • Paradox of caste: reservation politics • Desanskritization movements (Sarna, Ramnamis) • Link to Singer/Rowe: political participation > ritual status

2020	Anthro P2	20	Bring out the nature of social change in India with special reference to Sanskritization and Westernization.	• Full treatment: definitions, Srinivas on both • Cultural emulation examples (table of regional cases) • Impacts on women (loss of autonomy, dowry) • Westernization impacts (5 domains table) • Interrelationship + Nangeli case study • Conclude: both = processes of change, neither fully structural
2019	GS1	15	What are the challenges to our cultural practices in the name of secularism?	• Modernization vs cultural identity (Dube: less value-loaded) • Resistance to reform branded "Western" • Women's mosque entry, hijab controversy • Dabholkar anti-superstition movement
2017	Anthro P2	10	Discuss re-sanskritization and de-sanskritization with examples.	• Definitions of both variants • Lingayats (Karnataka) — Basavanna → re-adopted Sanskritic • Ramnamis (Chhattisgarh) — rejected priestly mediation • Sarna Revivalism (Jharkhand tribes) • Adi Dharma (Bengal Dalits)
2016	Anthro P2	10	Examine Modernization as a mechanism of social change in India.	• Eisenstadt + Yogendra Singh definitions • Indian model (Dube 1974): democracy/secularism/social justice • Daniel Lerner (empathy/mobility/participation) with Ambedkar examples • Limitations (5 points) • NCRB witchcraft data; Green Revolution gap
2014	Anthro P2	10	Critically evaluate Sanskritization as a process of social change.	• Srinivas definition + regional examples • Negative effects (women's rights lost, dowry) • Gould: repressed hostility motive • Critique: symbolic not structural • Singer/Rowe: political participation now dominant • Paradox of modern India

2. Religious & Linguistic Minorities

Year	Paper	Marks	Question	Answer Pointers
2023	GS1	15	What are the challenges faced by religious minorities in India? Discuss with reference to recent events.	• 7 problems (identity/security/equity/communal/representation/politicization/fear mongering) • Sachar: 2.5% bureaucracy data • Karnataka Hijab 2022; CAA 2019 • Lord Acton quote • Way forward: Ranganath Mishra Commission recommendations
2022	GS2	15	Discuss the constitutional provisions for the protection of minorities in India.	• Art 29, 30, 350-A, 350-B • "Minorities" appears only 4 places in Constitution • 6 notified communities (Jains added 2014) • 7th Amendment 1956 (Art 350-B) • DAV College case: spoken language sufficient • TA Pai Foundation: state-level determination
2020	GS1	15	What problems do linguistic minorities face in India? How can they be addressed?	• Definition (state-wide basis) • 6 problems (funds/diversity/grievance/discrimination/cultural erosion/economic) • XAXA Committee (PVTG literacy) • Art 350-A/350-B provisions • Solution: Ranganath Mishra recommendations, inclusive education
2018	GS1	15	How do religious minorities contribute to	• Census data (diversity itself = strength) • Art 29/30 — educational institutions

			nation-building in India?	• Contributions across fields • Conclude with Lord Acton: test of freedom = minority security
2015	Anthro P2	10	Discuss the problems of religious and linguistic minorities in India.	• Religious: 7 problems with examples • Linguistic: 6 problems with XAXA Committee reference • Case studies: Hijab, Muzaffarnagar, language death • Way forward: Ranganath Mishra, delink SC from religion

3. Growth of Anthropology in India

Year	Paper	Marks	Question	Answer Pointers
2023	Anthro P2	10	Trace the growth of anthropology in India with special reference to the contribution of Indian scholars.	• 4 phases (Formative → Evaluative) • S.C. Roy: "Munda & Their Country" (1912), "Man in India" (1921) • B.S. Guha: 1st Director AnSI (1945) • L.P. Vidyarthi: nature-man-spirit, sacred complexes • Verrier Elwin: The Baiga (1939), isolationist approach
2021	Anthro P2	15	Discuss the development of anthropology in India. Highlight the role of Anthropological Survey of India.	• 4 phases chronologically • AnSI (1945) under B.S. Guha at Calcutta • 25th Indian Science Congress 1938 — first review • Shift from descriptive → analytical (Phase 3) • Current: Medical Anthro, Development Studies, Action Research
2019	Anthro P2	10	Discuss the contribution of S.C. Roy to the development of Indian anthropology.	• "Munda & Their Country" (1912) — monograph • Founded/edited "Man in India" journal (1921) • Wrote on other tribes of Central India • Called "Father of Indian Ethnography" • Formative phase contribution; documentation of tribal life
2016	Anthro P2	10	Describe briefly the phases of growth of anthropology in India.	• Phase 1: 1774-1919 (Asiatic Society, Risley, S.C. Roy) • Phase 2: 1920-1949 (Universities, Man in India, AnSI) • Phase 3: 1950-1990 (Village studies, analytical, Vidyarthi) • Phase 4: 1990-present (Medical, Industrial, Applied)
2014	Anthro P2	10	Discuss the relevance of anthropology in contemporary India.	• Phase 4 developments (applied anthropology) • Tribal identity, development planning • Medical Anthropology (health programs) • Industrial Anthropology (workplace culture) • Action Research in tribal areas

4. Panchayati Raj & Social Change

Year	Paper	Marks	Question	Answer Pointers
2024	GS1	15	Discuss the role of Panchayati Raj Institutions in bringing social change at the grassroots level.	• 3-tier structure; direct democracy • Women reservation (Bihar 50% first); Sarpanch pati challenge

				• PESA for tribal rights • Case studies: Bhim tehsil alcohol ban, Latak bridge, Digampur • PPC 2025-26; SabhaSaar AI tool • Anderson & Parker definition of social change
2022	Anthro P2	10	Discuss PESA and its role in tribal self-governance.	• PESA — tribal customary/cultural/land/forest/mineral rights • Right to maintain own institutions • Pursue development per own aspirations • Link to PRI (Gram Sabha includes all) • Challenge: implementation gaps in many states
2020	GS2	15	To what extent have PRIs empowered women at the grassroots?	• Bihar first 50% reservation → 15 states • Sarpanch pati phenomenon (PM Modi raised) • Bhim tehsil: women-led alcohol ban • ACNielsen survey: PRIs addressing child marriage, alcoholism • Subhash study on women empowerment through media
2018	GS1	15	How have PRIs contributed to social change in India? Discuss with examples.	• Decentralized planning (Latak bamboo bridge) • Digampur: water supply, garbage collection (GPVY prize) • Odisha: environmental conservation through plantations • Health tracking: malnutrition, maternal deaths • Conclusion: PRI = tool of social change beyond mere governance

5. Media & Social Change

Year	Paper	Marks	Question	Answer Pointers
2023	GS1	15	Discuss the role of media as an agent of social change. What are its limitations?	• McLuhan: "medium is the message" • Positive: voice (Dongria Khond), awareness (honour killings), empowerment (#MeToo), language revival (Asur) • Negative: fake news, yellow journalism (CJI Ramana "kangaroo courts"), trial by media (Disha case), paid news • Conclusion: mirror + motor of change
2021	GS1	15	How has social media impacted the social movements in India?	• #MeToo, #BlackLivesMatter movements • Shaheen Bagh (CAA): organized via social media • Dongria Khond coverage → SC order • FRA 2006 loopholes exposed • Negative: fake news creating tensions; Bhima Koregaon
2019	Anthro P2	10	Discuss the role of media in social transformation with suitable examples.	• McLuhan definition • Positive impacts (6 with examples) • Asur community mobile radio (Sushma Asur, UNESCO) • Ghasi community upliftment • Subhash study (Gulbarga) • Negative: Disha case, Bhima Koregaon
2017	GS1	15	"Media is often accused of being an irresponsible watchdog." Comment.	• CJI Ramana: "kangaroo courts" • Disha case: media rallied for encounter justice • Paid news distorting elections • Bhima Koregaon: motivated arrests • Balance with positives: Niyamgiri, #MeToo • Need: self-regulation, media literacy

Universal Answer Building Blocks — Use Across Questions

Opening lines you can use:

- "As M.N. Srinivas observed in his seminal work on Coorgs (1952), social change in India operates through multiple, often contradictory processes..."
- "Lord Acton's dictum — 'the most certain test of a free country is the security enjoyed by minorities' — remains the touchstone for India's commitment to pluralism..."
- "Marshall McLuhan's insight that 'the medium is the message' acquires special significance in India where media both reflects and reshapes social hierarchies..."

Scholar Toolkit — Quick Deploy

When writing about...	Use these scholars
Caste mobility / social change	Srinivas (Sanskritization), Gould (repressed hostility), Singer/Rowe (political participation), Yogendra Singh (varna)
Western influence on India	Srinivas (Westernization), Huntington (clash), Said (Orientalism), Mahbubani (new Asian hemisphere), McLane/Nanda (nationalism)
Modernization / progress	Eisenstadt (historical process), Dube (less value-loaded, Indian model), Lerner (empathy/mobility/participation), Weber (Protestant ethic)
Minority rights	Lord Acton (freedom test), Sachar Committee (data), Ranganath Mishra (reservations), XAXA (tribal education)
Media & change	McLuhan (medium is message), CJI Ramana (kangaroo courts), Subhash (women study)
Local governance	Anderson & Parker (social change definition), Jodhka (values/institutions/practices)
Anthropology in India	William Jones (Asiatic Society), Risley (ethnography), S.C. Roy (Man in India), Elwin (isolationist), Guha (AnSI), Vidyarthi (analytical)

Case Study Quick-Deploy Matrix

Case Study	Use for Topics
Nangeli (Travancore)	Sanskritization hostility, caste oppression, women's resistance, social reform
Lingayats / Ramnamis / Sarna	Re/De-sanskritization, tribal identity assertion, religious reform
Dongria Khond / Niyamgiri	Media empowerment, tribal rights, FPIC, development vs indigenous rights
Karnataka Hijab (2022)	Minority rights, religious freedom, politicization, gender
Bhim tehsil alcohol ban	PRI & women empowerment, grassroots democracy, social change
Asur mobile radio	Media & language revival, linguistic minorities, tribal preservation
Disha case (2019)	Trial by media, criminal justice, media ethics